

Statement of intent

Baha Khammari · PhD position, auction-based support schemes for renewable energy
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Building the allowance price series for my final seminar paper took a week and produced the wrong variable. A plant holding free allocation against most of its verified emissions faces almost none of the headline EU ETS price. So I redefined the treatment as the price attenuated by the sector-year free-allocation share. The obvious objection is that allowances are tradable, so a lump-sum grant should leave the output margin alone. Activity thresholds, closure provisions and partial-cessation rules tie EU allocation to continued production. The distance between a posted price and the incentive it creates is a property of the rules.

My master's thesis asked whether a national scholarship programme in Brazil raised wages, and where. I built the panel from administrative records, roughly five million linked employer-employee observations across 558 microregions, 2005 to 2019, in R through BigQuery. My first specification was two-way fixed effects and returned -0.65 per cent. The Goodman-Bacon (2021) decomposition showed why. Already-treated regions were serving as controls for later-treated ones, and those comparisons carried enough weight to reverse the sign. Re-estimating with Callaway and Sant'Anna (2021) gives $+3.04$ per cent in low-exposure regions, distinguishable from zero at the 10 per cent level, on a dose-response that is non-monotonic. The thesis was graded 1.0. The estimator had been doing the work of the research design.

Of the four directions in the call I would take up pre-qualification with completion bonds, and local content requirements. Both govern what an award price means. A bid carrying a bond, a deadline and a sourcing constraint is a different instrument from one that carries none, the free-allocation problem in another market. Willems and Yu compare discriminatory and uniform-price auctions on short-run bidding and long-run investment, and a penalty regime that changes the mapping from bid to delivered capacity changes that comparison. Lété, Smeers and Papavasiliou (2026) work out what zonal pricing with market-based re-dispatch costs in efficiency. Europe has been generating the empirical counterpart for a decade, adopting auctions at different dates and revising penalties, bid bonds, deadlines and technology lots on different national timetables. That is staggered adoption with varying intensity, and it is the setting my thesis was built for.

In five to ten years I want to be the person in an energy group who can establish whether a design change did what it was meant to do. Doing that from inside the theory rather than beside it is what the doctorate is for, and it is the part I do not yet have. My master's microeconomics grade is 3.0 and the transcript shows it. Bachelor microeconomics is 1.0, and advanced microeconomics on strategic thinking and competition with Axel Ockenfels is 1.3, so the work ahead of me is graduate industrial organization. A group running auction theory and empirical energy economics along one corridor is where I want to do it.

Available from October 2026. French at B1, German and Tunisian Arabic natively, English at IELTS Academic 8.0. EU citizen. Referees: Prof. Dr. Pia Pinger and Jun.-Prof. Dr. Oliver Ruhnau, contact details on the CV. The thesis and the seminar paper are available on request.

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